

SHOPIFY PLAN & ALTERNATIVE

GNA Intern Chris | Intern Huiju

Table of Contents

01

Introduction

02

Why Shopify?

03

Shopify Plans

04

Alternative

05

Conclusion

Introduction

***Choosing the right e-commerce platform
→ crucial for business success***

According to various industry reports:

- 90% of companies see increased revenue and profits after upgrading their platform
- Businesses that deliver an outstanding customer experience can charge up to 16% more for their products or services
- Choosing the wrong platform results in high migration costs and operational risks

NEWS

Generating a better user experience drives ecommerce platform upgrades

Mark Brohan | Sep 25, 2024

All courses > Business administration > Ecommerce and Sales ::

Choosing the Right E-commerce Platform: Case Studies and Success Stories

What is Shopify?



A SaaS solution that lets sellers build and run an online store without any coding or development

It provides everything needed—product management, payments, shipping, inventory, marketing, and data analytics—all in one place

Qualitative Methods

- All-in-One, Fully Managed Platform
- Trust & Legal Compliance
- Integrated Business Tools

Quantitative Methods

- Scalable Plans & Global Reach
- Top-tier Performance & Security
- Proven Market Leadership

Why Shopify?

- 99.99% uptime with minimal server downtime
- 24/7 global official support
- Compliant with PCI-DSS, GDPR, and Australian Privacy Act

- Fully responsive design for mobile, tablet, and desktop
- 12 free themes available, including popular ones like Dawn

- Wide coverage from low-cost to enterprise level
- Starter (\$7/month) to Plus (\$2,300+/month) — scalable options for every stage of growth



Shopify Plan

Starter Plan

→ Small businesses or individual sellers

Standard Plan

→ SMBs launching online sales

Plus Plan

→ High-volume & fast-growing businesses
Large-scale enterprises with mass sales



Starter Plan

Strength

- Low cost, easy start
- Social selling without website
- Core selling tools included
- Fast payout via Shopify Payments

Weakness

- Hard to build brand identity
- Limited product organisation
- High transaction fees

\$1/month for first 3 months

Starter

\$7 AUD/month

Sell instantly through social media and messaging apps or a simple online store

[Learn more](#)

Limitations

- No custom domain or full website
- No SEO or content features
- No analytics or marketing tools
- No staff accounts/POS Pro
- Plan not available in some regions

Standard Plan *(Basic, Grow, Advanced)*

Strength

- Full shopify Payments with local bank transfer
- Supports major gateways (Stripe, PayPal, etc.)
- Localised fees & PCI Level 1 security
- Easy setup with ABN & live tax reports
- Scalable with themes, apps, and multi-store

Weakness

- Limited backend and checkout customisation
- Key features rely on paid apps
- POS pro upgrade requires extra fee

Limitations

- No full export or source access
- Limited local integration (ERP etc.)

\$1/month for first 3 months	\$1/month for first 3 months	\$1/month for first 3 months
Basic For solo entrepreneurs Starting at \$42 AUD /month billed once yearly	Grow For small teams Starting at \$114 AUD /month billed once yearly	Advanced As your business scales Starting at \$431 AUD /month billed once yearly

Plus Plan

Strength

- Handles 160K+ orders/min
- Advanced checkout & B2B support
- Dedicated manager & global control
- Automation & API scalability

Available on a 1- or 3-year term

Plus
For more complex businesses

Starting at
USD 2,300 ^{USD} /month
on a 3-year term

Weakness

- Very high monthly cost
- Limited full customisation
- App costs add up
- Complex multi-store setup

Limitations

- No server access or migration
- Limited security & POS freedom
- Theme & UX customisation limits
- Not fully local regulation-ready

Summary

Feature	Starter Plan	Standard Plan	Plus Plan
Payment Gateways	Major cards, PayPal only	Shopify Payments, Stripe, PayPal, Afterpay, etc.	Same as Standard
Online Fees	5% per transaction	1.75–1.4% + 30¢	Custom rates
Custom Domain/Site	Not available	Provided	Provided
Customisation	Not available	Partial (Liquid-based, limited)	Advanced checkout & full customization
Apps & Scalability	Not supported	Wide variety (free & paid)	Same + high-level API access
Analytics/Marketing	Not available	Standard analytics included	Advanced tools & expert consulting
POS	Lite only	Lite included, Pro requires extra cost	POS Pro
Staff Accounts	Not available	Available (based on plan tier)	Large-scale

Available on a 1- or 3-year term

Plus

For more complex businesses

Starting at

USD 2,300^{USD}/month

on a 3-year term

Alternative



A free, open-source plugin for WordPress that lets you fully customise and manage your online store—including products, payments, shipping, inventory, and design—in one platform, with complete control and flexibility

Qualitative Methods

- Open-source, fully self-owned
- Unlimited customisation
- Integration flexibility

Quantitative Methods

- No license or vendor lock-in
- Content and SEO power
- Best for custom needs

Comparison

Shopify

- Cloud-based SaaS subscription platform
- Shopify manages all infrastructure and data
- Very easy setup – no coding skills required
- Hosting, security, and updates handled automatically
- Best for users who want a fast launch without managing technical or security details



WooCommerce

- Open-source and self-hosted platform
- Full control over server, data, and security
- Highly customisable – requires development resources
- Supports deep integration with ERP, CRM, and other systems
- Ideal for businesses needing advanced features and complete technical control

Conclusion

Situation/Type	Recommended Platform	Main Reason
Testing sales via social media links	Shopify Starter	Very low cost, instant payments, no website needed
Building a new branded online store	Shopify Standard	Easy setup, marketing tools, automation, all-in-one management
Enterprise, multi-brand, cross-border	Shopify Plus	Handles high traffic, advanced checkout, dedicated support
Full customisation / in-house tech team	WooCommerce	Unlimited features, data ownership, complete control
Content or SEO-focused e-commerce	WooCommerce	Best for blogging, landing pages, and advanced SEO strategies
Fast launch / minimal management needed	Shopify (Std/Plus)	Automated operations, reliable support, easy to use

THANK YOU

